

Modular Arithmetic, Residues and Power Cycles

Diagnostic and coverage-hardening companion

TARGET MODULUS → REDUCE → CYCLE / THEOREM → LEGALITY → CHECK

Teacher-only companion - answer diagnostics and theorem-hypothesis checks

NT-02 - Teacher Diagnostic Key

Teacher/authoring material; not in the student PDF.

Recognition lab

1. $5 \mid (38 - 3) = 35$.
2. Not equal; congruent mod 12 because 12 divides 12.
3. $12345 \equiv 4 \pmod{7}$.
4. 2, 4, 1, 2.
5. Mod 10.
6. Mod 100.
7. Inverse 3 mod 7 is 5: $x \equiv 5 \cdot 6 \equiv 2$.
8. $\gcd(2, 6) = 2$, so 2 has no inverse mod 6.
9. $x = 2 + 3k$, then test mod 4.
10. Incompatible: residues disagree mod $\gcd(4, 6) = 2$.
11. Avoid $m \mid (A - B)$.
12. Base mod 7 and exponent mod 6 (for nonzero base states).
13. m divides a-b.
14. 5 inverse mod 12 is 5.
15. No: $\gcd(6, 15) = 3$.
16. $a^2 \equiv b^2 \pmod{9}$.

Practice answers

1. 6, 1, 1, 1.
2. difference 30 divisible by 10.
3. 3.
4. 0, 1, 2, 3, 4.
5. cycle length 3; $40 \pmod{3} = 1$, answer 2.
6. 7 powers mod 10 cycle 7, 9, 3, 1; $2026 \pmod{4} = 2$, answer 9.
7. 25.
8. inverse 3 mod 7 = 5; $x \equiv 25 \pmod{4}$.
9. $x \equiv 8 \pmod{15}$.
10. 3 has order 6; $100 \pmod{6} = 4$; $3^4 = 81 \pmod{4}$.
11. 2^{2025} last digit 2; 3^{2025} last digit 3; sum last digit 5.
12. inverse 5 mod 12 = 5; $x \pmod{40}$ congruent 4.
13. divide condition correctly: $4(x-2)$ divisible 12 $\rightarrow x \pmod{3}$ congruent 2; classes 2, 5, 8, 11 mod 12.
14. $\gcd(6, 9) = 3$; difference 3 divisible 3, compatible.
15. numbers 3 mod 4: 3, 7, 11, 15, 19, ...; first 5 mod 7 is 19.
16. $3^{20} \pmod{100} = 1$, so last two digits 01.
17. induction from $25 \cdot 5 = 125$ congruent 25 mod 100.
18. 3.
19. 6.
20. polynomial operations preserve congruence.
21. $2 \cdot 1 \pmod{8}$ congruent $2 \cdot 5 \pmod{8}$ but 1 not congruent 5 mod 8.

22. $6x = 9 \pmod{15}$ has no solution because $\gcd(6,15)=3$ divides 9; divide by 3 gives $2x \equiv 3 \pmod{5}$, $x \equiv 4 \pmod{5} \rightarrow$ classes 4, 9, 14 mod 15.
23. $2^{1000} \pmod{7} = 2$, $3^{1000} \pmod{7} = 4$; total 6.
24. $11^2 = 121 \pmod{21}$, powers mod 100 cycle? Direct binomial $(1 + 10)^n \equiv 1 + 10n \pmod{100}$; $n=2026$ gives 61.
25. $\gcd(6,9)=3$; residue difference 3 divisible 3, compatible. $x = 4 + 6k$; $k \pmod{?}$? $4+6k \pmod{9} \rightarrow 6k \pmod{9} \rightarrow 2k \pmod{3} \rightarrow k \pmod{3}$; least $x=16$.
26. $7(x-2)$ divisible 21 $\rightarrow x \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$; residues 2, 5, 8, 11, 14, 17, 20.
27. 31.
28. preserve zero set $\rightarrow 7|T$; preserve all nonzero base powers $\rightarrow 3^T \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$, order 6 $\rightarrow 6|T$.
29. $\gcd(10,30)=10$; cancellation only reduces modulus to 3; conclusion is $x \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$.
30. $\gcd(4,6)=2$ but residue difference 3 not divisible 2: no solution.

H0 answers

1. $12 \mid (83 - 11)$.
2. Work mod 10; cycle of 7.
3. $\gcd(4,9)=1$; inverse exists.
4. $\gcd(6,9)=3$; difference 3 is divisible 3, so compatible.
5. $2026 \pmod{3} = 1$; answer 2.
6. 25.
7. inverse 5 mod 12 = 5; $x \equiv 35 \pmod{12} \equiv 11$.
8. $\gcd(6,18)=6$ divides 12; divide by 6: $x \equiv 2 \pmod{3} \rightarrow$ classes 2, 5, 8, 11, 14, 17.
9. 9.
10. $1234 \pmod{6} = 4$; answer $3^4 \pmod{7} = 4$.
11. $\gcd(4,6)=2$ but residue difference 1 not divisible 2: no solution.
12. powers of 7 mod 10 cycle length 4; exponent $7^7 \pmod{4} = 3$; answer $7^3 \pmod{10} = 3$.
13. $14 \mid 42$ is equivalent to $42 \equiv 0 \pmod{14}$; divisibility is the zero-residue special case of congruence.
14. Mod 7: inverse 3 exists $\rightarrow x \equiv 2 \pmod{7}$. Mod 9: $\gcd(3,9)=3$; reduce to $x \equiv 2 \pmod{3} \rightarrow$ classes 2, 5, 8 mod 9.
15. 31; below 14 pigeonhole, 14..30 each has a collision, mod 31 fourth-power residues are all distinct.
16. $2^n \pmod{7}$ cycles 2, 4, 1; $100 \pmod{3} = 1$; residue 2.

Diagnostic tags

- NT02-R1 equality/congruence confusion.
- NT02-R2 divisibility/congruence bridge missing.
- NT02-R3 wrong target modulus.
- NT02-R4 brute-force power instead of cycle.
- NT02-R5 illegal cancellation/inverse gap.
- NT02-R6 simultaneous-congruence compatibility gap.
- NT02-R7 base-period/exponent-period confusion.

NT-02 - Teacher Coverage Hardening Addendum

Status: STATIC_DIAGNOSTIC_ADDENDUM_V1 Issue: #132

This addendum synchronizes the learner-facing bounded Euler bridge in 03_First_Step_Reference.md. It does not alter historical-anchor answers or existing authored-item keys.

Euler's theorem

If $\gcd(a, n) = 1$, then

$$a^{\varphi(n)} \equiv 1 \pmod{n},$$

where $\varphi(n)$ counts the integers in $1, \dots, n$ that are coprime to n .

Independent proof-idea check

Let $r_1, \dots, r_{\varphi(n)}$ be a complete list of invertible residue classes modulo n . Multiplication by a permutes these classes because a is invertible. Therefore

$$(ar_1) \dots (ar_{\varphi(n)}) \equiv r_1 \dots r_{\varphi(n)} \pmod{n}.$$

The product $r_1 \dots r_{\varphi(n)}$ is invertible, so cancellation is legal, yielding

$$a^{\varphi(n)} \equiv 1 \pmod{n}.$$

Decision boundary

A large exponent does not automatically call for Euler. First reduce the base and inspect a short cycle/order. Use Euler only when $\gcd(a, n) = 1$ is explicit or cheaply checked and the theorem reduces work.

Fermat's little theorem - design companion

For prime p with p not dividing a ,

$$a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \pmod{p}.$$

This is included as a curriculum-design prime-modulus companion/corollary. The supplied preparation routine explicitly names Euler's theorem, not Fermat's little theorem.

Diagnostic codes

- NT02-EULER-1: coprimality not checked before Euler.
- NT02-EULER-2: exponent reduced by $\varphi(n)$ in a non-coprime case.
- NT02-EULER-3: totient machinery overused where a two- or three-step residue cycle is cheaper.
- NT02-FERMAT-1: modulus not checked prime.
- NT02-FERMAT-2: base divisible by prime modulus but Fermat invoked anyway.
- NT02-POWER-ROUTE: theorem/cycle choice not justified.

Evidence truth

This addendum is a static mathematics/diagnostic synchronization. It does not constitute classroom timing/readability, retention, psychometric, qualification/pass-mark or publication calibration; those remain NOT_RUN.